

found on the elite ultra-compact laptops worth Rs. 80,000 and above. The compact size and light weight was also the other very interesting characteristic in netbooks. The only major component missing in a netbook is the DVD drive. You'll have to purchase an external portable DVD drive for use with your netbook if you need one. With our online dependency increasing and the average disc space constantly on the rise, DVDs are becoming less important.



BenQ U121

It's been a little more than a year since the netbook phenomenon first began. Now, everywhere you go, every electronics shop is flooded with netbooks from every laptop manufacturer you can think of. You can see them at your local mall and showrooms.

I remember Acer, ASUS and MSI were the first ones to bring netbooks to the country and they're still around getting new models out. ASUS' EeePC has been a hit because of the first 1000H model which came with the 6-cell battery that keeps the netbook powered for well over 5 hours. The model was then priced at Rs. 26,000. Models with similar configurations are now available for a little less. Whichever netbook you go for, opt for one with a 6-cell battery or you'll be limiting yourself to around 2.5 hours of up-time with the standard 3-cell battery that most netbooks come with.

Since day one, the Acer Aspire One has always been a favourite for those who are looking for more than just utility from their netbooks. They're attractive to look at and are built pretty well except for a few design flaws that involve the keyboard and the trackpad. While I was at this mall, I saw the newer version of the Acer Aspire. Its 11.6-inch model is worth taking a look at.

Try and steer away from the Z5xx series of processor netbooks. While the Atom N270 isn't a very powerful CPU, the Z5xx series is in fact a slower single core processor. ASUS' 1101HA and BenQ's U121 are two models with larger screens, but they both use the Z5xx processors. If you want better battery life, models with this processor lineup will help. Netbooks with SSDs are a tiny bit lighter, but then you pay a premium for it.

Sony's netbook was also on sale. The VAIO W as Sony calls it, is